

ROBERT F. SWENSON III

Systems • Automation • AI • Networking • Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Industrial operations leader and hands-on systems builder with 21 years at RYAM, including 15 years as a Digester Lead Operator. Experienced in safety-critical process operations, troubleshooting interconnected systems, team coordination, and operational decision-making. Outside of work, design, integrate, operate, and troubleshoot Linux infrastructure, networking, security monitoring, automation, observability, local AI, and web applications. Seeking systems administration, network administration, infrastructure, NOC, automation, or related technical roles where operational discipline and practical systems experience can be applied.

CORE TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Systems & Infrastructure: Linux, Windows, macOS, Raspberry Pi, Docker, KVM, systemd, self-hosted services, remote administration

Networking & Security: TCP/IP, DNS, WireGuard VPN, Pi-hole, Wazuh SIEM, Suricata IDS/IPS, network troubleshooting, security monitoring

Monitoring & Automation: Prometheus, Grafana, Uptime Kuma, Portainer, monitoring/alerting, workflow automation, scheduled services

Development & AI: Git/GitHub, REST APIs, Python and JavaScript/TypeScript working familiarity, AI coding agents, requirements/specification development, testing/debugging, local AI integration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RYAM | Jesup, Georgia

C Digester Lead Operator | 2011 - Present

- Lead and coordinate complex digester operations in a continuous industrial production environment with emphasis on safety, reliability, quality, and process stability.
- Monitor interconnected process systems, operating data, alarms, trends, and equipment behavior to identify abnormal conditions and determine operational response.
- Troubleshoot process and equipment problems using real-time data, historical behavior, hands-on experience, and coordination across operations, maintenance, and supervision.
- Make and communicate operational decisions during equipment failures, process disruptions, shift transitions, and routine production activities.

RYAM | Jesup, Georgia

Operator I | 2005 - 2011

- Operated and monitored industrial production equipment and process systems, responded to changing conditions, and developed broad knowledge of plant systems, procedures, and safety requirements.
- Promoted to Digester Lead Operator in 2011.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Context-Aware Home Security Platform | *Self-hosted security and incident-awareness system*

- Built a Reolink-based platform with resident presence, HOME/AWAY/NIGHT/GUEST/VACATION modes, zones, incident correlation, trusted people/vehicles, camera health, and AI-assisted verification.
- Designed persistent incident lifecycle and context-aware automation so alerts can account for presence, location, zone, and security mode rather than treating every camera event equally.

Home Network Command Center | *Centralized network operations dashboard*

- Built a self-hosted interface for network health, device inventory, service availability, remote-node visibility, and security/monitoring data across home infrastructure.
- Integrated technologies including FastAPI, React, Prometheus, Pi-hole, WireGuard, Docker Compose, and Linux-based monitoring services.

Graydragon Personal Intelligence System | *Local-first personal intelligence and automation platform*

- Designed a system combining structured knowledge, scheduled intelligence processing, email/calendar integration, dashboards, automated workflows, and self-hosted AI.
- Integrated a GPU-backed local inference server using llama.cpp, CUDA, Qwen, and an OpenAI-compatible API while maintaining separation between test and production AI paths.

Mortgage Intelligence | *Automated monitoring and decision-support tooling*

- Built rate-monitoring and refinance-analysis systems with scheduled automation, deterministic scoring, Prometheus/Grafana observability, and a separate web application.
- Designed unattended Linux services for recurring data collection, restart resilience, alerting, and reduced manual monitoring.

ADDITIONAL TECHNICAL WORK

Homelab & Multi-Node Infrastructure | *Linux, networking, security, and observability*

- Operate Linux servers and Raspberry Pi nodes connected through WireGuard, supporting Docker/KVM workloads, Wazuh, Suricata, Prometheus, Grafana, Pi-hole, Portainer, and remote monitoring.
- Troubleshoot VPN connectivity, services, containers, exporters, telemetry, DNS, and multi-location infrastructure.

Contingency Brief / CrisisWatch | *AI-assisted crisis intelligence application*

- Developed a Next.js/Express application for global and local crisis monitoring, watched locations, threat feeds, breach exposure, phishing-risk analysis, notifications, and AI-assisted severity/geolocation.
- Backend architecture includes PostgreSQL/Prisma, authenticated per-user data, caching and cost controls for AI-backed operations, Stripe subscription infrastructure, and external API integrations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Systems: Linux, Windows, macOS, Raspberry Pi OS, Docker, KVM, systemd, self-hosted services

Networking/Security: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, WireGuard, Wazuh, Suricata, Pi-hole, switches, routers, network troubleshooting

Monitoring/Operations: Prometheus, Grafana, Uptime Kuma, Portainer, monitoring, alerting, service health, operational troubleshooting

Development: Git/GitHub, REST APIs, HTML/CSS, working familiarity with Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, databases, FastAPI, React/Next.js

AI/Automation: Claude Code, ChatGPT, AI coding agents, requirements specification, testing/debugging, workflow design, llama.cpp, Qwen, local inference integration

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

McDaniel Vending | Vending Operations | 2002 - 2005

Rogers State Prison | Correctional Officer II | 1997 - 2001

Blue Collar Air Conditioning | HVAC Technician | Approx. 1994 - 1997

EDUCATION & CONTINUING DEVELOPMENT

Georgia College & State University | College coursework

Altamaha Technical College / Coastal Pines Technical College | Technical coursework

CCNA-focused networking self-study | Current

High School Diploma | 1993

SELECTED CREDENTIALS

FCC Amateur Radio Extra Class License | KT4SW

PADI Open Water Diver